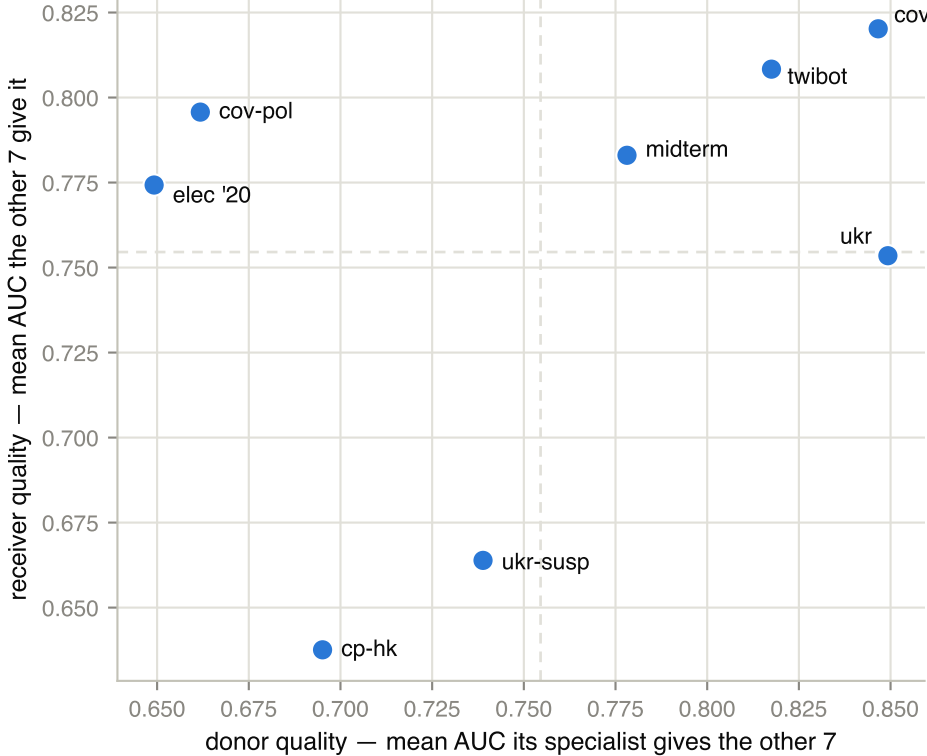


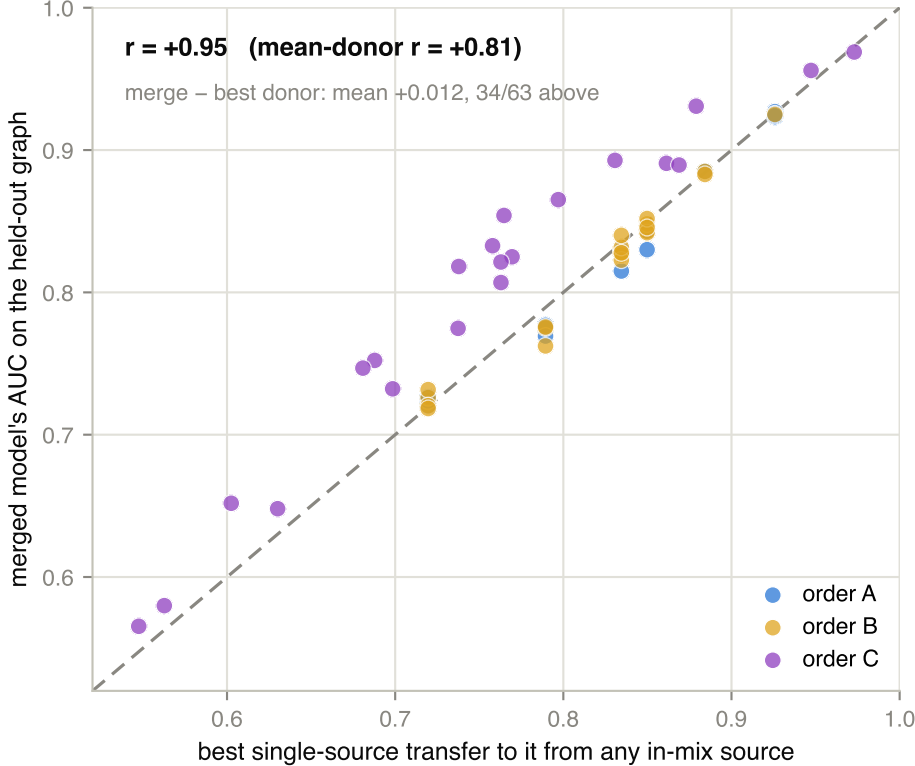
# Donor and receiver quality: measured by the single-source matrix, validated by the ladder

NM 3-shot / 30-way · matched step 40k · panel 1 = matrix row/column means (specialist models only) · panels 2–3 = the 3-order ladder scored against matrix-derived predictors  
panel 2: every held-out (graph, rung) cell at merge size  $\geq 2$  (63 cells; rung-1 cells excluded — they are the single-source rows themselves) · panel 3: all 21 measurable entry events

who gives well, who receives well  
(single-source matrix alone)



a merge serves an outside graph like  
its best member would alone



the entry jump is the unserved part:  
ceiling – best donor present

